

This is the most accurate way to prepare ...b7-b5.

14 Be3

White could also contemplate 14 a4 to stop ...b7-b5 but after 14...c4!
15 Be3 Nc5 16 Bxc5 (otherwise the knight infiltrates on d3)
16...Qxc5+ 17 Kh1 Nd7! the black pieces co-ordinate well.

14...b5 15 a3 Nb6! 16 e5

16 Bf2 is an important alternative. White more or less abandoned this move after the game Kozul-Nunn, Wijk aan Zee 1991. Play continued 16...Nc4 17 Qc2 Nd7 18 Be2 Rab8 19 a4 b4 20 Bxc4? bxc3 21 b3 a6! (this keeps the bishop out of b5) 22 Rec1 Nb6 23 Bf1 c4! 24 Bxc4 Nxc4 25 bxc4 Rb2 with a winning position for Black. Vaisser, however, has tried to rehabilitate this line for White. Instead of 20 Bxc4 he gives 20 Nb5! Nxb2 21 Nxd6 b3 22 Qb1 Nxa4 23 Ra3! as unclear. To be honest, nobody really knows what's going on in this position.

16...Nc4! 17 exf6 Nxe3 18 Rxe3 Rxe3 19 fxg7 Rae8 (Diagram 4)

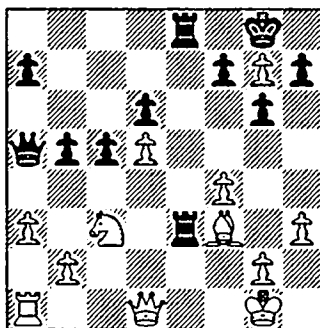


Diagram 4

Black has more than enough play

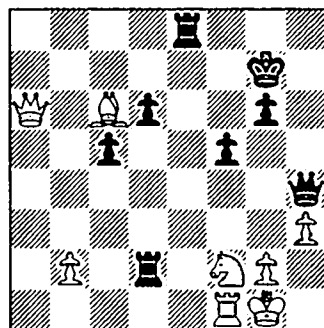


Diagram 5

White forces Black to find the win

This is the position Black had in mind when he embarked on the complications with 15...Nb6. White has a slight material advantage but this is compensated for by the fact that the black rooks are extremely active and the mobility of the white bishop is restricted by the pawn on d5. The pawn on g7 is of course doomed.

20 f5 b4 21 axb4 Qxb4 22 Qd2 Qb4! 23 fxg6 hxg6 24 Rf1 a6! 25 Nd1

Amazingly enough, this is the first new move of the game. Previously 25 Qf2 Qd4 26 Kh1 R3e5! had been played. White can probably hold the ending but it is more pleasant for Black.

25...R3e5 26 Nf2 f5 27 Bd1?! Kxg7 28 Qa5?! Rxd5 29 Bf3 Rd4 30 Qxa6 Rd2! 31 Bc6?? (Diagram 5)

White totally lost the plot over the last few moves and he caps it off with an outright blunder. 31 Qa3! still offered hope.

31...Re1!

Now 32 Rxe1 Qxf2+ 33 Kh2 Qxe1 just loses a piece. Black is threatening 32...Qxf2+ anyway and the only way to stave off immediate defeat is by 32 Nh1. After the game my opponent said that he would rather resign than play such a sick move.

32 Qb7+ Kh6 33 Ng4+ fxg4 34 Qf7 Rxf1+ 35 Qxf1 Kg7! White resigns

Game 48

□ Vaisser ■ Bauer

French Cup 1992

1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nc3 Bg7 4 e4 d6 5 f4 0-0 6 Nf3 c5 7 d5 e6 8 Be2 exd5 9 cxd5 Re8 10 e5

This leads to enormous complications. White can also defend his e-pawn:

1) Not with 10 Qc2? as there is the trick 10...Nxe4! 11 Nxe4 Bf5 12 Bd3 Bxe4 13 Bxe4 Qe7 14 Nd2 f5 when Black regains the piece and remains a pawn to the good.

2) 10 Nd2, however, is an important alternative. The current view is that Black obtains good play after 10...Na6 11 0-0 Rb8!.

10...dxe5 11 fxe5 Ng4 12 Bg5

12 0-0 Nxe5 leads to a similar sort of position. The passed d-pawn is always going to provide White with some compensation for the pawn.

12...Qb6

After this move Black will at least get a pawn for his troubles. If he plays 12...f6 he will have no compensation for his suffering. A typical continuation is 13 exf6 Bxf6 14 Qd2 Bxg5 15 Qxg5 Qxg5 16 Nxg5 with an advantageous endgame for White.

13 0-0 Nxe5 14 Nxe5

14 d6 is also played quite often. Vaisser gives the following exciting variation as best play: 14...c4+! 15 Kh1 Qxb2! 16 Rc1 Nxf3 17 Bxf3 Bxc3 18 Rb1! Qxa2 19 Bd5 Bf5 20 Rxf5 gxf5 21 Bxf7+ Kxf7 22 Qh5+ Kf8 23 Bh6+ Bg7 24 Qxf5+ Kg8 25 Qd5+ Kh8 26 Bxg7+ Kxg7 27 Qg5+ with a draw by perpetual check.

14...Bxe5 15 Bc4 (Diagram 6)

White plans an attack against the f7-square.

15...Bf5!? 16 Nb5

White needs to play d6 even if it costs him dear.

16...a6! 17 d6!

White can't back out now. He is willing to sacrifice the kitchen sink to get at the black king.

17...axb5 18 Bxf7+! Kxf7 19 Rxf5+! gxf5 20 Qh5+ Kf8!

Vaisser relates how for many years this move was thought to lose be-

cause of some erroneous analysis which even he believed. 20...Kg7 is also good enough for a draw but 20...Ke6 loses.

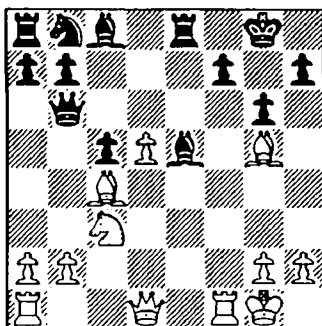


Diagram 6

White has a strong attack

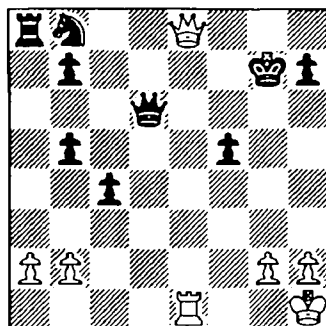


Diagram 7

How should Black defend?

21 Bh6+

In a later game (Vaisser-Apicella, French Ch. 1996) White made a half-hearted winning attempt with 21 Qxh7 but after 21...Qxd6 22 Bh6+ Qxh6 23 Qxh6+ Bg7 24 Qd6+ Kg8 25 Qd5+ Kh8 26 Qxf5 Nc6 27 Qh5+ Kg8 28 Qd5+ Kh7 29 Qf5+ he took the perpetual check. Black has more than enough material for the queen so White would only risk losing by playing on.

21...Bg7 22 Bxg7+ Kxg7 23 Qxe8 c4+ 24 Kh1 Qxd6 25 Re1 (Diagram 7) 25...Qf8!

This came as a great shock for Vaisser. According to theory at the time Black was supposed to play 25...Ra6 here and lose after 26 Re7+ Kh6 27 Qf8+ Kg5 28 Qg8+. After Bauer's new move it quickly dawned on Vaisser that if he didn't take perpetual check it was going to be he who lost the game.

26 Qc5+ Kg8 27 Qd5+ Kh8 28 Qe5+ Draw agreed

That is about as theoretical as it gets in the King's Indian. In his book on the Four Pawns Attack, Vaisser spends the equivalent of 80 (yes, that's eighty) pages purely on the analysis of 9...Re8.

Game 49

□ Blokh ■ Kichev

corr USSR 1991

1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nc3 Bg7 4 e4 d6 5 f4 0-0 6 Nf3 c5 7 d5 e6 8 Be2 exd5 9 cxd5 b5?!

This move has led a chequered existence. First it was the main line and then was condemned as unsound. Then it bounced back because of 10...Nfd7 but now it is on the way out again. The tactical justifica-

tion lies in the fact that Black can meet 10 Bxb5 with 10...Nxe4! 11 Nxe4 Qa5+ 12 Nc3 Bxc3+ 13 bxc3 Qxb5 12 Kf2 is better but after 12...Qxb5 13 Nxd6 Qa6 Black has good compensation for the pawn, 10 e5! (Diagram 8)

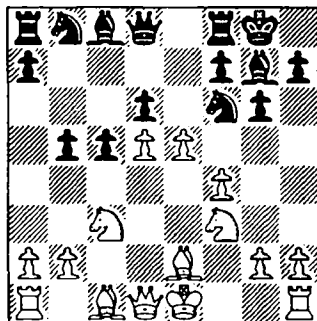


Diagram 8

White strikes in the centre

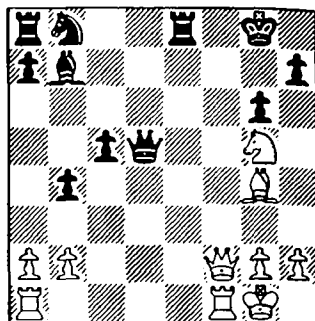


Diagram 9

Black must accept a lost endgame

10...dxe5

The Ukrainian grandmaster Frolov had some initial success with 10...Nfd7 until it was established that 11 Bxb5! leaves Black in a difficult position. After 11...dxe5 12 0-0 White should meet both 12...Ba6 and 12...Qb6 with 13 a4!. The d-pawn is very strong in this position

11 fxe5 Ng4 12 Bg5 f6

As in Game 48 Black has the choice between this move and ...Qb6. 12...Qb6 is not quite as effective here as the pawn on b5 gets in the way of the queen but Vaissier still considers it the lesser evil

13 exf6 Bxf6 14 Qd2 Re8

Both 14...Bxg5 15 Nxc5!? and 14...Bf5 15 0-0 b4 16 Nd1 Nd7 17 Nf2! are in White's favour. The main problem for Black is White's d-pawn.

15 0-0 b4 16 Nd1 Bb7 17 Nf2! Bxg5 18 Nxc5 Nf6 19 Ng4! Nxc4 20 Bxg4 Qxd5 21 Qf2! (Diagram 9)

Because of his exposed king Black is forced into an ending where he loses the exchange immediately.

21...Qd4 22 Qxd4 cxd4 23 Be6+ Rxe6 24 Nxe6 Nc6 25 Rf6 Ne5 26 Raf1 Nd7 27 Rf7 Bd5 28 Rg7+ Kh8 29 Rxd7 Bxc6 30 Rxd4 Bxa2 31 Rxb4 a5 32 Rb7 Black resigns

6...c5: Early Deviations

1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nc3 Bg7 4 e4 d6 5 f4 0-0 6 Nf3 c5 7 d5

This is by far the most common reaction. White blocks the centre and

plans to follow up with e4-e5. He can also play 7 dxc5 and this leads to a completely different sort of game. That is the subject of Game 51.

7...e6

The most logical move. Black plans to exchange on d5 in order to open the e-file for his rook. There is another strategy which involves sacrificing the b-pawn in order to gain some open files on the queenside for his major pieces. This usually starts with 7...b5!? 8 cxb5 a6!.

8 Be2

White prepares to castle. An alternative is to play 8 dxe6. A very different sort of position will arise where White hopes that his active pawns on e4 and f4 will enable him to develop a kingside attack. The main drawback to 8 dxe6 is that after 8...fxe6 9 Bd3 Nc6 the knight has easy access to White's main weakness, the hole on d4.

8...exd5 (Diagram 10)

Now the main line is 9 cxd5 but in Game 50 we examine the alternative capture 9 exd5.

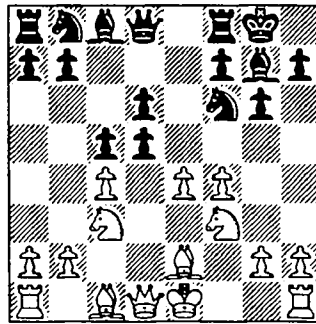


Diagram 10

White has three possible moves

The speculative 9 e5?! enjoyed a period of popularity in the 1980's but was discarded because of the reply 9...Ne4!. On a rare return to top level chess, Barsov-Ye Jiangchuan, FIDE World Championship, Moscow 2001, White had nothing new to show. After 10 cxd5 Nxc3 11 bxc3 Nd7! 12 e6 fxe6 13 dxe6 Nb6! 14 0-0 Bxe6 15 Ng5 Bd5! Black was a pawn up with active pieces. 10 Nxd5 is also possible but after 10...dxe5 11 fxe5 Nc6 12 Bd3 f5 Black has a good game.

Theoretical?

Nowhere near as theoretical as the previous section but Black should at least know the initial plan against each line. He ignores these variations at his peril, as the statistics below make only too clear.